

The Money Climb

Financial literacy · teens–adult · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

“If I gave you \$1,000 right now, what happens to it in the next 48 hours? Be honest.” (Every answer is a financial personality confessing.)

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Climb until the group meets a compound-interest question and a debt question — pause on both; those two ideas are the whole war.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. Who taught you about money — and what did they get right or wrong?
2. Why does compound interest make the patient rich and the borrower poor — same math, opposite ends?
3. What’s the difference between looking rich and being free?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Five questions at own pace.

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Money is a tool; interest is its engine — choose which side of the engine you live on.”

Homework: Find one recurring charge you forgot you pay; decide its fate out loud next session.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.